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SomeHats
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Staff product engineer
Interaction designer

She/her • Remote, NZ • Updated November 2026

I make things for people who make things.

I'm a staff product engineer with 13 years of experience building creative tools and developer platforms at companies like tldraw and Airtable. I work across the whole product, from who it's for and what it should be, to how it feels and the plumbing inside. Good tools feel like superpowers. Giving people that feeling is what drives my work.

Work History

Staff Product Engineer • tldraw

January 2023 - October 2025

tldraw makes an infinite-canvas SDK used by teams like Autodesk, ClickUp, and Mobbin. I joined as the fifth hire and owned work across the canvas, SDK, releases, support, and product.

- Point person for SDK design. Designed APIs every tldraw app builds on, including shape relationships, custom styles, snapping, undo/redo, and image exports. Built canvas features alongside them, such as elbow arrows and the highlighter.
- Ran the SDK's regular releases, including 4.0, and wrote most of the release notes. Stayed in constant contact with customers on Discord and GitHub to get them unblocked and inform what we needed to build in the SDK next.
- Led our most-requested feature, multiplayer sync, from internal code to product. I defined what the product should be, designed the public API and extension points, and shipped it with hosting templates and docs. Customers used it to replace in-house sync and ship new multiplayer features.
- Built early AI-on-canvas experiments, from prototypes (agents drawing directly on the canvas in 2023) to public launches such as tldraw computer, teach and draw fast.
- Ran the starter kits initiative to get people building on the SDK faster: I built npm create tldraw, the most-requested starter kits (workflows, chat, multiplayer), and set up the process for other team members to contribute kits easily.
- Managed external contractors, and stepped in to get a partner project with an external agency and major cloud provider back on track.

Staff Product Engineer • Airtable

January 2019 - July 2022

My role grew and changed with the company as it scaled from 70 to over 1,000 people.

- Tech lead on the platform and ecosystem team. I developed our ecosystem strategy, led the team to ship our third-party extension tools and marketplace, and coordinated a group of external contractors.
- Created Airtable's scripting environment. My initial idea and one-week prototype proved popular with users and internal stakeholders, and scripting became a key priority as the company stepped from no-code to low-code. Read more.
- Delivered customer training webinars on our developer tools, and spoke at AWS re:Invent 2020 about how we run untrusted scripts safely.
- One of three founding engineers on Interface Designer, a major 0→1 initiative to build the third pillar of Airtable's product strategy after data and automations. I designed and built the drag-and-drop layout builder at the core of the product.
- After the launch of interface designer, we rolled out a number of tooling and process improvements from the project to the whole engineering org.

Sabbatical and freelance

October 2025 - Present

A year in New Zealand's mountains. Part-time R&D for friends' startups on AI agents, realtime partial sync for SQLite, mobile app prototypes, and building with agentic coding tools.

Earlier

- **Consultant product engineer and facilitator, 2017–2019**. A one-person product shop, taking UK non-profits from rough idea to tested MVP.
- **Software Engineer, Music Glue, 2016–2017**. Rebuilt the e-commerce platform as Node.js services behind a single GraphQL API, with a fast React storefront.
- **Co-founder and CTO, Erase All Kittens, 2013–2016**. Created an award-winning game where children edit a level's HTML and CSS as they play. It is still active and has introduced hundreds of thousands of children to coding.
- **Developer, Decoded, 2013–2014**. Designed workshops & built the live coding environment used in every Decoded workshop.

Teaching & facilitating

Before I got obsessed with building tools that let people be creative with computers, my focus was on teaching the skills to do so instead. I've designed and taught a degree-level software engineering bootcamp whose graduates joined Google, Meta and EY, taught business executives to build IoT devices, and introduced 7-year-olds to game design. Co-author of JavaScript Made Easy (DK, 2018).